

giving lessons and designing parts that could be moved around to achieve the functions needed for the robot being built. As they worked around with these laser cut parts, they slowly found themselves working towards a larger dream – a flexible kit that people could use to learn, teach or simply play around with!

The open twist: Multiplo is a kit that has everything you need to build a robot. All the parts have been tested for compatibility, and there is also the flexibility to add your own parts. It comprises a set of mechanical parts that are easy to assemble, difficult to break and simple to customise. The system is based on a mathematical relationship between the dimensions of the components, making them match each other. The makers also decided to design and manufacture their own controller because they wanted something user-friendly, yet powerful and hackable – so they developed DuinoBot, an all-in-one, expandable, Arduino-compatible robot controller with motor outputs, easy to use sensor connectors, etc. While they provide graphical software for programming the system, for beginners they also have a simple set of pre-recorded actions that can be commanded with a common TV remote control. The system works completely out-of-the-box, and you can easily build a robot within an hour. You can re-program its controller, add Arduino-compatible shields like Wi-Fi and GPS, or your own custom-made parts. The whole system is open source, and the parts have also been designed such that they can be reproduced using simple tools. All mechanical blueprints, laser-cutting files, robot projects, software examples and documentation are open source and have been released under the RMPL licence.

An 83.82 cm (33-inch) open source multi-touch table

<http://playsurface.org/>

A multi-touch display is a wonderful thing to have – whether for entertainment, collaboration or for teaching. However, it is also expensive, placing it out of the reach of most people. Playsurface, which was demonstrated at this year's Consumer Electronics Show, might change all this. The project is an attempt to bring large format touch computing tables to developers, consumers and home users. It is based on what the team believes to be a new mechanical and electronic design approach. The kit, which will start shipping in the near future, will include a complete touch table and all the open source drivers and demo programs needed to start working with it. The Playsurface features a new, application-specific closed-loop digital image processing module to provide touch detection and tracking functions, apart from the gaming/application computer. It also includes an open hardware cabinet and surface design developed for cost optimisation and flat-pack shipping, as well as a USB interface and



driver that makes the touch table implementation as easy as plugging in a mouse or a hard drive.

The open twist: Playsurface was incubated within Templeman Automation (TA), a product development firm in Somerville, Massachusetts. At TA, a team of engineers was working on developing software to manipulate digital representations of physical assets in a given space – for example, moving furniture around when designing interiors. In the midst of their efforts they realised that a multi-touch interface would be much more useful for this purpose than a mouse. They checked out existing multi-



REQD FREELANCER team to complete balance work of a **FOSS WEB APPLICATION** (CentOS, PHP, postgresql and apache server) already **Fully Documented**, **Screens Data Structures**, **Menu Completed**,

for one or all of :

- Coding, testing, implementation
- Cloud deployment
- Mobile deployment
- Conversion to different languages
- Conversion of speech to text
- Splitting to several small modules for different level usage

The Web application is a financial management and commerce management product

Work To Be Done At Chennai, Tamil Nadu On Contract Basis,
Payment Basis: Lump Sum or Partnering /
Profit Sharing During Maintenance Can Also Be Considered.

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